Stele

possibly Tulunid or Ikhshidid, c. 3rd-4th centuries AH / 9th-10th centuries CE

Wood

W: 22.5 cm; H: 51 cm

Inv. no. 9526



"In the name of God, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. God is the replacement for every loss and the solace for every calamity. And the greatest calamity is the calamity of the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him. This is the grave of Ahmed ibn Abdullah, may God have mercy on him, forgive him, and be pleased with him."

This wooden funerary stela commemorates a figure named Ahmad ibn ʿAbdallah and bears a Kufic inscription invoking God's protection from calamity and asking for mercy and forgiveness for the deceased. The multi-register script shows notable, though not exact, affinities with another wooden panel in the Museum's collection (Inv. No. 3914) linked to Abu Muhammad ʿAbd Allah al-Tabataba (d. 338 AH / 949 CE) and recovered from the Ikhshidid mausoleum of al-Tabataba in ʿAyn al-Sira.

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